

Unity creates interactive applications for many platforms. While it is primarily a tool for creating games, it has a number of other uses. It can also be used to create a number of non-gaming applications that could be used for a variety of purposes like architectural walkthroughs, teaching aids, or as a touch interface for controlling other applications. Not a repurposed game engine, it is a game engine that has been built from the ground up. This ensures that game designers are not limited to preconfigured games and have the freedom to design their games with different kinds of layers and features as they would like.

Unity is multi-platform. It can deploy to a number of platforms like MacOS, Linux, Windows, Windows Phone, iOS, Android, Blackberry, etc. It also can work for consoles if you get the desired licenses – consoles like Xbox, PlayStation, etc. It is a versatile platform that allows you to create many different types of games that can then be deployed to various different platforms.

Examples of popular Unity 2D games

- Children of Morta - Dead Mage
- Pixel Ripped - Pixel Ripped Inc.
- Tiny Bubbles - Pine Street Codeworks
- Cuphead - StudioMDHR
- Flipping Death - Zoink Games
- Night in the Woods - Finji
- Phased - EpicHouse

The game development pipeline

Before getting to developing a game, it is a good idea to understand the game development pipeline. You can get away with using small snippets of code, which is technically scripting for the first few games. If you are familiar with C# or Java, most of this will be a cakewalk. There is a particular language used for shaders though, which you might have to learn. However, that is only for the most advanced parts of using Unity.

The best place to start is with pen and paper. It is a good idea to sketch out and take notes on how the game will work, what the play area will look like, what is the look and feel of the game, how the control systems will work, how the UI will look, what is the target platform for the game, scoring and gameplay mechanics. This is known as the concept phase. Once the game is conceptualised, the rest of the pipeline can be broken down into three parts – pre production, production and post production.